

Story itself. And who is this who now begins to write at such length, and so methodically, what sounds like a piece of carefully composed history (vss. 47 ff.), and with such disproportionate interest in "the priests and the Levites" (vss. 52-56) and in "instruments of music" (4:63, 5:2)? These are the pet interests of the Chronicler himself; his peculiar property, in fact.

There is, indeed, plain evidence of composition in this long sequel, 4:43-5:6, showing that it consists of the work of the interpolator *plus* the work of the Chronicler. In the verse 5:6, especially, we can see how a harmonistic gloss has been added to the original text. The date, as it stands, is altogether out of place; and, indeed, it is difficult to imagine a reason for telling in any place the day of the month on which Zerubbabel made his successful speech. The words just preceding the date, "he who spoke wise words before Darius," are an obvious gloss, the last of the redactional patches by means of which the two documents were combined. This statement of year, month, and day was originally the Chronicler's date of the return from Babylon. Commentators have wondered why such a date was missing, in this history in which month and day of the month are never wanting, and on this occasion which overshadowed all others in importance. Verse 6 originally read: "in the second year of the reign of Cyrus, the king of Persia,⁹ in the month Nisan, on the first day¹⁰ of the month." The interpolator was, of course, obliged to alter "Cyrus" to "Darius" (as also in 5:2), and the insertion of his gloss necessitated a slight change in the wording of the sentence. Whoever examines 5:1-6 closely will see that it is written throughout in the characteristic phrases of the Chronicler, and this is true also of much of the latter part of chap. 4. The redactor's part is, indeed, as we were led to expect, a comparatively small one. Two brief passages, purely harmonistic, and easily recognized, are all that he has added, namely, vss. 43-46 (with the first clause of vs. 47) and vss. 57-61.¹¹

This conclusion, as to the Chronicler's authorship of 4:47-56 in particular, receives important confirmation from without. In

⁹ The phrase "king of Persia," מֶלֶךְ פֶּרְס, is a well-known mark of the Chronicler's hand.

¹⁰ In the Greek, τοῦ πρώτου μηνός, "the first month," is derived by some mistake from בִּאֲחֶר לַחֹדֶשׁ, as many have observed.

¹¹ These two patches, small as they are, contain some things of interest. Observe the statement regarding the Edomites, in vs. 45, and the very unusual phrase "king of heaven," in vss. 46 and 58.